.gitignore File

Meaning: A **.gitignore** file is used in Git to tell Git which files and folders should be ignored and not tracked in a repository.

Example of .gitignore file

```
# Python files
__pycache__/
*.pyc

# Environment files
.env

# Virtual environment
venv/
env/

# IDE files
.vscode/
.idea/

# Temporary files
*.tmp
*.log

# System files
.DS_Store
Thumbs.db

# Build files
build/
dist/
```

Importance of .gitignore

1. It ignores unnecessary files.
2. It prevents uploading temporary files.
3. It keeps the Git repository clean.
4. It helps avoid tracking sensitive information.
5. It reduces unnecessary files in the repository.

Example: If we add `*.log` in the `.gitignore` file, Git ignores files that end with `.log`.